

MARICARMEN SMITH-MARTINEZ

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STRATEGIC GROWTH & PARTNERSHIPS EXECUTIVE with extensive cross-sector leadership experience in international development and nonprofit strategy, specializing in organizational growth, partnership development, and mission-aligned portfolio expansion. Adaptable leader with a proven ability to scale impact through cross-cultural collaboration, USG engagement, and global operations oversight. Resilient strategist recognized for spearheading multimillion-dollar international portfolio growth while strengthening organizational infrastructure to support long-term sustainability. Committed changemaker known for cultivating high-value partnerships and connecting strategic vision with purpose-driven implementation.

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

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|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| ✓ Strategic Business Growth | ✓ International Development | ✓ Stakeholder Engagement |
| ✓ Cross-Sector Partnerships | ✓ Nonprofit Leadership | ✓ Portfolio Management |
| ✓ Global Program Operations | ✓ Fundraising Strategy | ✓ Organizational Transformation |
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE & ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Azuvila – Washington, DC (Hybrid) **11/2025 – Present**

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

- Leads strategic business growth and stakeholder development for small businesses in the government contracting market, providing advisory services including market trend analysis and business development strategy, capture management and positioning efforts, and proposal development
- Provides nonprofit strategy consulting including fundraising assessments, revenue diversification analysis, donor pipeline evaluation, and organizational capacity reviews

Bixal – Fairfax, VA (Hybrid) **11/2013 – 11/2025**

Senior Director, Strategic Growth & Partnerships **10/2023 – 11/2025**

- Developed and executed a comprehensive partner strategy to expand Bixal's industry leadership across U.S.-based institutions, global networks, and governmental entities
- Fostered strategic relationships with U.S. government clients, key stakeholders, and subcontractor networks to drive long-term business growth and sector presence
- Led pursuit and analysis of new business development opportunities, leveraging digital transformation trends and mapping partnership alignment for impact scaling
- Elevated organizational visibility through speaking engagements and international representation, amplifying strategic narratives across diverse global venues, including events in Thailand and Ghana
- Directed capture trips in Peru and Guatemala to activate stakeholder relationships with 10 local partners, key personnel, and USAID Mission officials, deepening regional business positioning

Senior Director, Global Operations **01/2022 – 10/2023**

- Oversaw a \$38M international portfolio supporting USAID Missions in Libya, Burma, the Caribbean, and Nepal, strengthening operational delivery across three continents and complex field environments
- Established a new international programs unit by recruiting and leading a cross-functional home office team, enabling cohesive overseas implementation across 3 continents
- Directed a practice of 25+, including six direct reports, to align program workflows with corporate objectives and ensure technical compliance and operational agility
- Successfully transitioned three international contracts from start-up to operational execution, navigating global logistics, compliance, and staffing challenges

Director, International Development Sector **01/2020 – 12/2021**

- Expanded international program portfolio from \$0 to \$53M by leading partnership development, opportunity capture, and digital services alignment with enterprise goals

- Guided business development unit to scale global initiatives across digital transformation and Agile program contexts, managing market presence and client relationships
- Led go-to-market strategy and external representation through targeted collateral, stakeholder events, and association participation to position Bixal as a market innovator
- Facilitated the complex transition of four USAID-funded programs (~\$15M), orchestrating digital platform transfers, new and incumbent staff recruitment, team integration, and operational handover

Program Manager / Housing Counselor SME

11/2013 – 01/2020

- Led successful capture, proposal, and programmatic startup for USAID's \$28.5M KDLT contract, advancing knowledge, evaluation, and organizational learning activities across resilience and food security ecosystems
- Managed \$5.5M in direct projects and oversaw nearly \$6M across federal (i.e., HHS, HUD), nonprofit, and corporate partners to scale M&E, digital learning, and technical communications
- Directed cross-disciplinary agile teams through large-scale learning product development, including module design, digital training platforms, and certification for HUD housing counseling initiatives

CredAbility (*now Money Management International*) – Atlanta, GA 01/2013 – 11/2013***Financial Education Specialist***

- Built regional coalition of over 300 faith-based, nonprofit, and business organizations to amplify financial education strategy within eight months
- Conducted 15+ monthly in-person and virtual workshops to deliver financial literacy support to 400+ attendees monthly across underrepresented communities
- Generated partnership revenue by designing sponsor-aligned education initiatives, connecting programmatic impact to funding streams through strategic stakeholder engagement
- Led translation and e-learning integration of over two dozen financial education offerings, expanding program access for Spanish-speaking audiences

Community Foundation for Greater Atlanta – Atlanta, GA

06/2012 – 11/2013

Community Coach, Neighborhood Fund Program

- Provided capacity-building support to grassroots organizations, delivering technical assistance and leadership training to enhance program sustainability

Atlanta Habitat for Humanity – Atlanta, GA

06/2009 – 01/2013

Homeowner Selection Manager

07/2010 – 01/2013

- Led outreach strategy and application process for 500+ families annually, supporting homeownership programming in partnership with real estate initiatives to build 45 and rehabilitate 15 houses each year
- Managed two staff and 40+ volunteers across committees to ensure campaign and compliance accuracy throughout the selection lifecycle
- Partnered with technology leads to transition agency CRM to Salesforce, improving applicant tracking and cross-departmental engagement workflows

Homeowner Outreach Coordinator

06/2009 – 06/2010

- Increased homebuyer applications sourced from outreach efforts by 430% within six months and increased Hispanic applicant pool by 100% through targeted bilingual outreach and regional media campaigns
- Supervised 30 volunteers and logged 100+ outreach events annually to drive visibility and community participation in affordable housing programs

Peace Corps – Costa Rica

02/2006 – 05/2008

Volunteer, Rural Community Development

EDUCATION

Master of Global Affairs and Management (MGAM), Global Management
Thunderbird School of Global Management, Arizona State University

Bachelor of Arts (BA), Spanish | Religion Minor
Emory University

Certificate, Space Leadership, Business, & Policy
Thunderbird School of Global Management, Arizona State University

TECHNICAL

Salesforce • SharePoint • Microsoft 365 • G-Suite • Adobe Acrobat • Drupal

CERTIFICATIONS

Former: Project Management Professional (PMP), Advanced Certified ScrumMaster (A-CSM)

AWARDS

President's Volunteer Service Award – Lifetime Achievement

40 Under 40 Award, National Peace Corps Association

National Peace Corps Association Board Emeritus

40 Under Forty Award, Emory University

COMMUNITY

O Lab, an Okhtapus nonprofit <i>Founding Board Director</i>	08/2025 – Present
Museum of the Peace Corps Experience <i>Board of Directors, Secretary Governance Committee Chair Nominating Committee Chair</i>	07/2025 – Present
National Peace Corps Association <i>Governance Committee Board of Directors, Chair Board of Directors, Affiliate Group Network Coordinator</i>	05/2014 – Present <i>09/2021 – Present 08/2018 – 09/2021 05/2014 – 08/2018</i>
Atlanta Area Returned Peace Corps Volunteers <i>President Vice President 50th Anniversary Committee</i>	7/2011 – 12/2013 <i>12/2012 – 12/2013 08/2011 – 12/2012 01/2011 – 09/2011</i>
United Way of Metropolitan Atlanta <i>Community Investment Volunteer</i>	01/2013 – 11/2013
Habitat for Humanity in Atlanta <i>Family Selection Committee Member</i>	01/2013 – 11/2013
New Leaders Council – Atlanta Chapter <i>Finance Chair</i>	08/2011 – 08/2013

